

Between the Lines — Paper B

MEDIUM • 35 MINUTES • 25 MARKS

NAME

DATE

SCORE / 25

- Answer **every** question in the space provided.
- Read **both** texts once, properly, before you answer anything. The last two questions need both.
- Answer only from the lines the question names. A perfect answer from the wrong lines scores nothing.
- When a question asks for **two things**, give two separate ideas. One idea written twice is one mark.
- Pay attention to punctuation and spelling. The number of marks is shown in brackets [] on the right.
- The ladder: **Says** (what happened) → **Shows** (what the writer chose to put there) → **So what** (what that implies). A question asking what something *tells* or *suggests* wants the third rung, proved with the second.
- For any explanation mark: **quote short, zoom to one word inside your quotation, then say what it suggests**. An inference with no word behind it scores the same as a blank.

Text A — Vikram is thirteen. For three weeks a stray dog has been sitting behind the stumps at evening practice on the maidan, and the team has started to argue about it.

- 3 The dog arrives at ten past five, which is four minutes after Vikram does, and sits
4 down behind the stumps as though somebody has paid it to be there. It is brown, with
5 one ear that will not stand up, and it watches the ball and not the boys. When a shot
6 goes past it, the ear lifts. It never once chases.
- 7 'It's going to get hit,' says Adil, who is captain this month and enjoys it.
- 8 'It's been three weeks and it hasn't been hit,' says Vikram.
- 9 'That's not an argument.'
- 10 'It's the same argument you used about the tree.'
- 11 Adil throws the ball from hand to hand and does not answer, which is what he does
12 instead of agreeing.
- 13 The truth, which Vikram does not say, is that he has been bringing half a chapati in
14 his kit bag since the second week, and that the dog knows the sound of the zip. He
15 has worked out the exact place to leave it — behind the roller, where nobody walks
16 — and the exact moment, which is while the others are arguing about the light.
- 17 On Thursday the dog is not there.
- 18 Practice goes on. Vikram takes two wickets and does not enjoy either of them. At six
19 the boys start packing up and he finds himself walking the long way round the maidan,
20 past the roller, past the gap in the fence, looking at the ground rather than at
21 anything in particular.

22 It is behind the water tank, lying on its side, breathing in a way he does not like.
23 There is a cut across one back leg, straight and clean, the kind a sheet of roofing
24 metal makes.
25 He does not know what to do, so he does the only thing he can think of, which is to
26 sit down on the concrete beside it and stay there. After some time the ear lifts.
27 He is still there at seven, when the lights on the far side go on, and he has missed
28 dinner, and he has not once thought about the two wickets.

Text B — A week later a letter arrives from Vikram's grandmother in Thrissur. She writes by hand, in English, once a month.

30 My dear Vikku,
31 So you have a dog. I notice you did not say the word 'dog' anywhere in your letter. You
32 said 'it' fourteen times. I counted, because I am old and I have time.
33 You ask me whether you should tell your mother. You did not ask me whether you should
34 keep feeding it, which tells me you have already decided that part.
35 Now listen. I am not going to say what you want me to say. A dog that is fed by one
36 boy at one time in one place is not a free animal any more; it will wait for you on
37 the day you have exams, and on the day you go to Mysuru, and it will not understand.
38 Kindness that comes and goes is a hard thing to be on the end of.
39 Either it is your dog or it is the maidan's dog. Half is worse than neither.
40 Your grandfather said the same thing to me about a cat in 1971 and I did not speak to
41 him for two days, and then I got the cat properly, and he fed it for eleven years
42 without once saying anything about it.
43 Come in December. Bring the dog if by then it is yours. — Ammamma

SECTION A – READING

1. Look at lines 3-6.

(a) Give **two** things that show this dog does not behave like an ordinary stray. [2]

- (b) What does *which is four minutes after Vikram does* tell the reader? Tick (✓) [1]
one box.

The dog is always slightly late

Vikram has been timing it, so he has been watching for some time

Practice always begins at ten past five

The dog follows Vikram to the maidan

2. Look at **lines 13-24**.

- (a) Give a short phrase from lines 13-14 that shows Vikram has kept the feeding [1]
to himself.

- (b) Give **one word** from lines 22-24 that means 'a wound made by something [1]
sharp'.

3. Look at **lines 17-21**. Give **two** things that show Vikram is more worried about the [2]
dog than he will admit.

SECTION B – QUOTATION AND EXPLANATION

4. Look at **lines 25-28**. Which of these opinions do you agree with most? Tick (✓)
one box, then give **two** quotations that support the opinion you chose, and explain
how each one supports it.

Vikram sits with the dog because he cannot think what else to do.

Vikram sits with the dog because he has already decided it is his.

Quotation 1

[1]

Explanation 1

[1]

Quotation 2

[1]

Explanation 2

[1]

5. Look at **Text B (lines 30-43)**. Vikram’s grandmother is deliberately blunt with him. Give **two** quotations that show this, and explain how each one does.

An example has been given.

Quotation: *I counted, because I am old and I have time.*

Explanation: she makes a joke at her own expense, which lets her admit she has studied his letter closely without sounding as though she is prying.

Quotation 1

[1]

Explanation 1

[1]

Quotation 2

[1]

Explanation 2

[1]

SECTION C – THE WHOLE TEXT

6. Look at **lines 35-38**.

(a) Give **one word** that means ‘not owned or controlled by anyone’. [1]

(b) What does *Kindness that comes and goes is a hard thing to be on the end of* tell the reader about her view of what Vikram has been doing? [1]

7. What does *Half is worse than neither* (line 39) mean here? Tick (✓) **one** box. [1]

Half a chapati is not enough food for a dog

A partly-kept promise leaves the dog worse off than none at all

Two owners are worse for a dog than one

The team should share the responsibility between them

8. Look at **Text B**. What features tell the reader that this text is a personal letter rather than a printed article? Give **two** features. [2]

9. Look at the **whole text**.

(a) Vikram and his grandmother have each understood that the dog is no longer really a stray. Give **one** phrase from each text that shows this. [2]

- (b)** Put these events into chronological order, numbering them from first (1) to last [3] (5). **One** example has been done for you.

Event	Order of events
Vikram begins bringing half a chapati	1
Vikram sits on the concrete until seven	
The letter arrives from Thrissur	
The dog does not come to practice	
Vikram finds the dog behind the water tank	

End of paper. Before you hand it in, check every explanation names a word from inside your own quotation. That is the mark most often left behind on a paper like this.